

1. For any sense experience, I can imagine a situation which is indistinguishable from that sense experience but in which my environment is not as the experience says it is.
 2. If I cannot distinguish between two situations, then I cannot know which of them is real.
 3. I can never know whether any sense experience of mine is accurate. (1,2)
 4. If I cannot know whether any of my sense experiences are accurate, I cannot know whether there is an external world.
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C. I do not know whether there is an external world. (3,4)

1. For any sense experience, I can imagine a situation which is indistinguishable from that sense experience but in which my environment is not as the experience says it is.
 - 2*. If I cannot distinguish between two situations, then I should not believe that one but not the other is real.
 - 3*. I should never believe that any sense experience of mine is accurate. (1,2*)
 - 4*. If I should never believe that any sense experience of mine is accurate, I should never form beliefs about the external world.
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C*. I should never form beliefs about the external world. (3*,4*)

Our second reading for today is from someone who has a very different perspective on our beliefs about the external world than Descartes did.

According to G.E. Moore, it is no “scandal to philosophy” that we cannot prove the existence of the external world — for in fact, he thought, proofs of this kind are extremely easy to give.

More and more positive rule of belief which we have already discussed:

Let's now hold that up against the rule of belief which figured in our argument
for skepticism.

The seeming impossibility of replying to Descartes' argument — and hence the seeming impossibility of providing a satisfactory proof of an external world — was seen by the great German philosopher Immanuel Kant as a “scandal to philosophy.”

Doubt $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you cannot rule out a situation which would make P false, you should not believe P.

At first glance, these rules look perfectly consistent. Moore tries to show that they are not.

Good Argument $\rightarrow$ Belief

If there is a valid argument for P and you should believe each of that argument's premises, you should believe P.



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